



ROSAIAH TAKING OVER AT THE CHIEF MINISTER'S OFFICE

HYDERABAD | The Mourning After

The sensitive and tactful Konijeti Rosaiah marked time until the traditional one-month mourning for Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy was over. On October 5, after a wait of 31 days, Rosaiah occupied the chief minister's office in the state secretariat, moving from his old office of finance minister. Aware that many YSR loyalists saw his son Jaganmohan as his heir apparent, Rosaiah chose to attend the chief minister's office on a day when AICC President Sonia Gandhi arrived in the state to commiserate with those who had lost their near and dear ones in the floods. The AICC had already made it abundantly clear that the time wasn't ripe yet for Jaganmohan—a first term MP and media baron—to become chief minister. The Congress feared that Jaganmohan would not be able to capitalise on the groundswell of support before the 2014 general elections. Before his sudden death in a chopper crash on September 2, YSR had declared his mission to win all 42 Lok Sabha seats from Andhra Pradesh in the next elections. It is a tall order that the party cannot fulfil without him. This is why the Congress wants to ride on the strategy of having a seasoned leader like Rosaiah at the helm now and install Jaganmohan as chief minister as the next Assembly election nears. But, for the moment, the resolute Rosaiah is standing up to call the shots.

by Amarnath K. Menon

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days was how long Rosaiah waited to move into the chief minister's office at the secretariat.